The Dhāraṇī Called the Unobstructed Subtle Vajra

Vajrasūkṣmāpratihatanāmadhāraṇī · Toh 955 · Derge Kangyur

རྡོ་རྗེ་ཕྲ་རྒྱས་ཐོགས་པ་མདེ་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī Called the Unobstructed Subtle Vajra, known in Sanskrit as the Vajrasūkṣmāpratihata nāma dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as rdo rje phra mo thogs pa med pa zhes bya ba'i gzungs, is a short scripture centered on the recitation of protective spells. It opens with the Blessed One absorbed in the meditative absorption of vajra knowledge, while the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, appears before him with a blazing countenance. A brahmin youth, emanated from the Buddha's mind, then asks Vajrapāṇi to proclaim the secret mantras, vidyā-mantras, and dhāraṇī-mantras that fiercely destroy those who oppress the weaker gods and nāgas of the three divine abodes. The text is Toh 955 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the collection of incantations valued for their protective and purifying power.

In the language of India: vajrasūkṣma apratihatanāma dhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī Called the Unobstructed Subtle Vajra.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas!

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was absorbed in the meditative absorption of vajra knowledge. Through the power of the Buddha, the Lord of Secrets, called Vajra hūṃ, displayed a blazing countenance and sat before the Blessed One.

At that time a brahmin youth arose from an emanation of the Blessed One's mind and spoke these words to the Lord of Secrets: "Lord of Secrets, Lord of Knowledge, Lord of Dhāraṇīs, please proclaim the secret mantras, vidyā-mantras and dhāraṇī-mantras that fiercely and utterly destroy those who oppress the weak gods and the weak nāgas in the three divine abodes."

Vajrapāṇi said: "Brahmin youth, listen well and hold it in mind. I proclaim this innermost essence, ever recited by all the sugatas and wrathful ones:

namo ratnatrayāya namaścaṇḍavajrapāṇaye mahāyakṣasenāpataye tadyathā oṃ hāra hara vajra matha matha vajra dhuna dhuna vajra daha daha vajra paca paca vajra dhara dhara vajra dāraya dāraya vajra dāruṇa dāruṇa vajra cchinda cchinda vajra bhinda bhinda vajra hūṃ phaṭ namaścaṇḍavajrakrodhāya hulu hulu tiṣṭha tiṣṭha bandha bandha hana hana amṛte hūṃ phaṭ

"Brahmin youth, whoever assumes the form of the sugata Amṛtakuṇḍalin and proclaims these vajra words of all the wrathful ones, and, emanating countless subtle vajras from all the pores of the body, sends them forth in the ten directions, will purify the bad habitual tendencies of all sentient beings. Life and merit will greatly increase, and one will be freed from enemies, from poison and from untimely death.

"Whoever focuses on a hostile, evil adversary, visualizing him as a magita plant shattered by a storm cloud, or as a fresh emblic fruit pressed with gold, and speaks these vajra words and sends forth the subtle vajras, will swiftly bring about the destruction of that adversary's five aggregates and five faculties.

"If a god recites it, then within one divine month or five years the heads of the asuras will split apart. If a monk recites it, the weapons of Māra will swiftly be subdued. If a human recites it, the one on whom he focuses will surely be destroyed within one human month or five human years."

The Blessed One said "Excellent!" to Vajrapāṇi and the brahmin youth, and then vanished. Then that brahmin youth, raising his Brahmā-like voice, proclaimed these vajra words throughout the three divine abodes.

The dhāraṇī called the Unobstructed Subtle Vajra is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The clause about the weak gods and nāgas is read as asking for mantras that destroy those who oppress them. It could also be construed as mantras that overpower the weak gods and nāgas themselves.

The phrase "all the sugatas and wrathful ones" could also be read as "all the wrathful sugatas."

The two similes for the visualized adversary are obscure. "Magita plant shattered by a storm cloud" renders a phrase whose first term (rtsi ma gi ta) could not be identified with confidence. "Fresh emblic fruit pressed with gold" renders a phrase whose exact sense is uncertain.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of

spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.